

Annemarie Grass

Head of Cyber Defence

Email: annemariegrass123@outlook.com

An experienced leader with over 10 years leading both operational and technical teams across cyber domains. Specialist in cyber incident response, threat hunting, and implementing detection and response capabilities. I am passionate about building, operating, and enhancing organisations defensive security, responding to security incidents, and uplifting overall security maturity.

Professional Experience

- Head of Cyber Defence | IDP Education Pty Ltd | June 2023
- Senior Manager, Defensive Security | PricewaterhouseCoopers (PwC) | July 2022
- Manager, Defensive Security | PwC | June 2021
- Cybersecurity Lead Forensics & Information Intelligence | AGL | January 2020
- Cybersecurity Lead 3rd Party Security Management | AGL | October 2018
- Lead Financial Crime AML/Sanctions | NAB | May 2018
- Senior Business Analyst | NAB | March 2016
- Senior Change Analyst September | NAB | September 2015

Training and Education

- Foundations of Directorship | Australian Institute of Company Directors | 2024
- Charles Sturt University | Master of Information Technology; Cybersecurity | 2020
- Nuix | Workstation Data Discovery Specialist | 2019
- Adaptive Frameworks | PRINCE 2 – Foundation and Practitioner | 2014
- Griffith University | Bachelor of Business; Mgr. Management and Human Resources | 2013

Demonstrated Skills and Strengths

- Ability to effectively bridge the gap between heavily technical environment and business strategy requirements to deliver outcomes to an organisation, achieved through balancing communication styles across stakeholders at all levels.
- Collaborative approach to problem solving, with ability to engage teams and bring them on the journey to achieve outcomes for organisations.
- Experienced Incident Responder coordinating activities for major multi-national organisations and global operations. Routinely manages multiple teams of investigators spanning across technology, internal audit and business assurance functions, profiles threat actors, works closely with senior executives on sensitive investigations and leading meaningful Post Incident Reviews.

Employment History

IDP Education Ltd
Head of Cyber Defense
Dimensions and Key Achievements

- Responsible for the establishment of the Security Operations Centre, including development of technical incident response plans, playbooks and training and onboarding of new security operations analyst.
- Responsible for leading the establishment of a Cyber Deliver Centre in Manila from initial market scan, vendor partnering and onboarding of 18 experienced cyber security practitioners to support IDP in delivery of it's Cyber Uplift Strategy.
- Responsible for the establishment of a Global Crisis Management Framework for IDP Education, working and engaging with senior executives to develop and refine the framework.
- Accountable for the delivery of several global incident response activities, working with regional technology teams to improve detection, response and recovery capabilities for regional technology teams responsible for local technology infrastructure.
- Led the global rollout of new Endpoint Detection and Response toolset for Servers and Workstations.
- Development of detection rule sets for cloud-based infrastructure assets, onboarding these into IDP Security Incident Event Monitoring platform.
- Established forensics capabilities to support whistle blower investigations globally.
- Presented on the progress against the Cyber Uplift Program to the IDP Board and led a board level incident response exercise focusing on key decisioning around recovery and response.
- Delivered NIST Maturity Uplift across the following domains (maturity uplift results determined by external vendor audit)
 - Protect 1.90 (2022) – 2.7 (2025)
 - Detect 1.30 (2022) – 3.2 (2025)
 - Respond 2.08 (2022) – 3.6 (2025)

PwC

Senior Manager Defensive Security July 2022

Dimensions and Key Achievements

- Security Operations secondment to a multinational mining company for a five-month period reporting directly to the Global Vice President, with responsibilities that include
 - Identifying and delivering on opportunities to uplift the company's Cyber Threat Intelligence function, Security Operations – Security Orchestration Automation Response (SOAR) tooling implementation, detection, and response capability.
- Development of operating models for incident response capabilities, where the capability is responsible for servicing external and internal client stakeholders, including government agencies.
- Incident responder responsible for leading client engagements for organisations large and small to detect, contain, and recover from cyber security incidents. Responding to several major ransomware incidents, as well as incidents involving business email compromise and accidental data exposure.
- Development of thought leadership pieces with respect to security operations, ransomware in the supply chain.
- Delivery of presentations to board members on contemporary cyber threats organisations are facing, bringing real world experience to the conversation to improve organisations preparedness to response to cyber incidents.
- Member of the 'She's Here' in Technology working group and was responsible for the coordination and delivery of PwC International Women's Day campaign for 2023. In addition to this I mentor female STEM graduates across PwC globally supporting females in reaching their full potential in the workforce.

PwC

Manager Defensive Security June 2021

Dimensions and Key Achievements

- Led engagements reviewing Cybersecurity submissions to regulatory bodies to validate funding requirements to uplift Cyber maturity in line with regulatory frameworks.
- Delivery of post incident reviews for major ransomware incidents, supporting clients in understanding the value of reflection and helping clients to identify and capitalise on opportunities to improve capability and build resilience after a cyber incident.
- Led the development and delivery of cyber crisis simulations for top executives and boards at several ASX10 and other major organisations.
- Coaching and mentoring junior team members on development of client engagements, this included 4 months in PwC Skilled Services Hubs developing our team's defensive security capability through the development and delivery of internal training.

AGL Energy

Cybersecurity Lead – Forensics & Information Intelligence January 2020

Dimensions and Key Achievements

- Leading a team of forensic investigators and cyber security engineers.
- Delivery of eDiscovery infrastructure (Nuix) on AGL Azure platform, reducing reliance on external vendors and reduction in data leaving the AGL environment
- Leading the delivery of eDiscovery RFP identifying best in breed external suppliers to work on AGL Nuix infrastructure to continue to develop eDiscovery capability at AGL
- Implementation of Azure Information Protection for all AGL users
- Responsible for both CASB DLP, Zscaler DLP infrastructure and ongoing policy development, refinement
- Developing information intelligence capability at AGL utilising industry leading technologies, OSINT and threat hunting
- Lead forensics investigations (including fraud, code of conduct violations) in coordination with internal teams, associated 3rd parties and government agencies.
- Collection and analysis of digital evidence in case of regulator investigation, legal request, or insider investigation
- Identify and analyse key pieces of intelligence information to provide input to business led security investigations
- Conduct forensics investigations into cyber related incidents within AGL.

AGL Energy

Cybersecurity Lead 3rd Party Security Management October 2018

Dimensions and Key Achievements

- Development of AGL strategy for management of existing and new 3rd party vendors
- Assessing and reporting on the security posture of AGL security relative to data security and fraud prevention controls
- Lead internal investigations on suspected or actual internal fraud activities this includes coordinating examining of technology pertinent to the investigation, stakeholder engagement, remediation strategy and reporting close out.
- Ensure that Security Incidents relating to data loss are captured in accordance with the Security Incident Management process. Monitor for Root cause analysis and remediation actions and assigned to owners to close the Incident with evidence.
- Provide reports to AGL's Privacy Officer where the security of AGL's data is weak or presenting risk of breach, work with the Privacy Officer and the business on treatment plans.

Relevance to GDAC-SA Tender

Annemarie brings over 10 years of cybersecurity leadership experience with proven capability in establishing Security Operations Centres, implementing NIST Cybersecurity Framework, and leading incident response for multinational organisations. Her expertise in securing cloud-based infrastructure, developing detection and response capabilities, and coordinating global security operations is directly applicable to protecting the GDAC-SA Advanced Analytics Platform and Saudi Arabia's sensitive geological datasets.

Key qualifications include:

- Established Security Operations Centre including incident response plans, playbooks, and analyst training
- Led establishment of Cyber Delivery Centre with 18 experienced cybersecurity practitioners
- Delivered measurable NIST maturity uplift: Protect (1.90→2.7), Detect (1.30→3.2), Respond (2.08→3.6)
- Developed detection rule sets for cloud-based infrastructure assets and SIEM integration
- Led global rollout of Endpoint Detection and Response toolset for servers and workstations
- Established Global Crisis Management Framework working with senior executives
- Led incident response for major ransomware incidents, business email compromise, and data breaches
- Security Operations secondment to multinational mining company implementing SOAR tooling and threat intelligence
- Delivered eDiscovery infrastructure (Nuix) on Azure platform with forensics capabilities
- Board-level presentations on cyber threats and incident response exercises
- Master of IT in Cybersecurity from Charles Sturt University